



DaSSA Hackathon 2026

Student Rubric & Evaluation Guide

(Applies to Clinsight × Lextrack AI × Ricoh)

Total Score: 100 Points (+10 Bonus)



How Your Project Will Be Evaluated

Your project will not be judged only on whether it “works.”
It will be evaluated on:

- Depth of thinking
 - Technical rigor
 - Business usefulness
 - Clear explanation
 - Real-world practicality
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1 Problem Understanding & Business Framing (10 Points)

What You Must Show:

- Clear explanation of the problem
- Who the user is (business owner / growth team / technician)

- Why this problem matters
- What success looks like
- Key assumptions you made

To Score High:

- Don't jump straight into coding
 - Explain the business objective first
 - Define measurable goals
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2 Data Handling & System Design (15 Points)

A. Data Exploration & Preprocessing (7 pts)

Show:

- Meaningful EDA (patterns, anomalies, trends)
- Cleaning logic
- Feature extraction (if applicable)
- Chunking strategy (for RAG systems)

Avoid:

- Minimal preprocessing
 - Copy-paste generic EDA
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B. System Architecture Design (8 pts)

You must explain:

- End-to-end pipeline
- How components connect
- What tools/models are used

For example:

- Clinsight → Review → Theme detection → Impact scoring → Dashboard
- Lextrack → Product input → Subreddit scoring → Post generation
- Ricoh → Query → Retrieval → Agent reasoning → Citation-backed answer

A simple architecture diagram is highly recommended.

3 Technical Depth (20 Points)

This is about how deep your solution goes.

Clinsight:

- Go beyond sentiment analysis
- Quantify theme impact on ratings
- Detect recurring issues
- Provide structured insights

Lextrack:

- Use ranking logic

- Provide reasoning for subreddit selection
- Include rule-awareness or spam prevention logic

Ricoh:

- Multi-document retrieval
- Iterative reasoning or query refinement
- Evidence-backed synthesis

To Score High:

- Don't build a shallow solution
 - Show layered logic
 - Demonstrate explainability
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4 Modeling & AI Strategy (20 Points)

You must clearly explain:

- Why you chose this model
- How the model works
- What alternatives you considered
- Why your approach fits this problem

If using LLMs:

- Explain prompt strategy
- Explain grounding method

- Show limitations

Hybrid approaches (keyword + semantic, topic + regression, etc.) are encouraged.

Avoid:

- “We used GPT” without explanation
 - No reasoning behind choices
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5 Evaluation, Grounding & Metrics (15 Points)

You must include:

- At least 5 example test cases
- Output results
- Clear metric explanation
- At least 1 evaluation visualization

Explain:

- Why you chose the metric
- What it measures
- Limitations

Examples:

- Clinsight → Theme impact score validation
- Lextrack → Relevance scoring validation

- Ricoh → Citation correctness + hallucination control

This is where many teams lose points.

6 Business Actionability (10 Points)

Your system must provide:

- Clear recommendations
- Structured output
- Decision-ready insights

Examples:

- Hospital improvement roadmap
- Reddit posting plan with cadence
- Troubleshooting steps for technician

Judges will ask:

👉 Can this be used tomorrow?

7 Visualization & UX (5 Points)

You should provide:

- Clear dashboard or structured output
- Easy-to-read results
- Ranked lists / retrieved sources visible

- Clean demo flow

Clarity > aesthetics.

8 Demo & Communication (5 Points)

During presentation:

- Explain logic clearly
 - Show system working live
 - Keep within time limit
 - Ensure balanced team participation
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Bonus Points (Up to +10)

You may earn bonus points for:

- Agentic multi-step reasoning
- Hybrid retrieval systems
- Multi-modal features
- Multi-lingual support
- Spam detection logic
- Hallucination verification
- Advanced analytics depth
- Ethical AI considerations

Bonus points reward innovation — not complexity for the sake of complexity.



Final Score Breakdown

Category	Points
Problem Understanding	10
Data & Architecture	15
Technical Depth	20
Modeling Strategy	20
Evaluation & Metrics	15
Business Actionability	10
Visualization & UX	5
Demo & Communication	5
Total	100
Bonus	+10